

Stoic/grounding techniques specifically for health anxiety during medical uncertainty — Action Checklist

PRINT THIS PAGE AND KEEP IT SOMEWHERE VISIBLE

BODY SCAN FOR FIRST SIGNALS

- ☐ **Body Scan for First Signals:** Identify your primary physical anxiety signal within 90 seconds of a trigger, noting whether it starts in your chest, stomach, neck, heart, or head as your nervous system's earliest warning that uncertainty is triggering your threat response.
- ☐ **Body Scan for First Signals:** Track your secondary physical anxiety signals alongside your primary one so you can recognize escalation patterns before a small flare-up becomes a full meltdown that derails your entire day.
- ☐ **Body Scan for First Signals:** Use your body's physical response as an early warning system that triggers your coping toolkit, recognizing that the sensation itself is not dangerous but rather your ancient alarm system misinterpreting medical uncertainty as immediate threat.
- ☐ **Body Scan for First Signals:** Distinguish between physical sensations that signal anxiety (tightness, racing, lightheadedness) and actual medical symptoms requiring doctor contact, since health anxiety can make this distinction feel impossible but it remains learnable.

DOCUMENT THOUGHT PATTERNS

- ☐ **Document Thought Patterns:** Write down whether catastrophic interpretation dominates your thinking during flare-ups, where you assume the worst-case scenario is already happening rather than just being one of many possible outcomes.
 - ☐ **Document Thought Patterns:** Record if probability distortion shows up in your thinking, where you believe you're uniquely destined for bad outcomes despite knowing intellectually that the statistical odds don't support that conclusion.
 - ☐ **Document Thought Patterns:** Note whether action compulsion drives your behavior during uncertainty, where you feel an irresistible urge to research symptoms, call your doctor repeatedly, or perform body checks instead of sitting with not-knowing.
-

- **Document Thought Patterns:** Capture your time compression thinking patterns, where waiting for results feels physically unbearable and your mind insists that prolonged uncertainty will destroy your ability to function at all.

BUILD YOUR REFERENCE TOOL

- **Build Your Reference Tool:** Complete the Anatomy of a Flare-Up worksheet by filling in your five specific answers about physical signals, thought patterns, triggers, worseners, and helpers to create a personalized intelligence document for crisis moments.
- **Build Your Reference Tool:** Store your completed worksheet somewhere immediately accessible on your phone notes or bedside table so you can reference it within seconds when panic starts building rather than losing it in a notebook.
- **Build Your Reference Tool:** Pull out your worksheet during an actual flare-up and read through it slowly to remind yourself that you have been in this exact territory before and survived it, interrupting the spiral with factual self-knowledge.
- **Build Your Reference Tool:** Update your worksheet regularly as you learn more about your anxiety patterns, understanding that this document is a living tool rather than a one-time exercise and your signatures may shift over time.

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.